Prepflow

DAILY EDITION · FOR TONY DIBBIN

# Saturday, 17 October 2026.

Your daily radio show prep — three top news stories, forward-looking showbiz, sport that matters this week, talkback prompts, and day notes for today and tomorrow. Built fresh every weekday, ready by 3pm for tomorrow's show.

00 — WEATHER

## Tomorrow's forecast

| LONDON | BIRMINGHAM | MANCHESTER | GLASGOW |
|---|---|---|---|
| Light drizzle | Overcast | Mostly clear | Clear |
| 14° 8° | 12° 7° | 12° 5° | 11° 4° |

01 — NEWS

## Today's top stories

1 **The Princess of Wales is launching a new project to encourage children to learn more from nature.**
Catherine believes a greater emphasis on the natural world can help with children's emotional growth. It's part of her ongoing work supporting early childhood development.
ROYALS · UK

2 **Ministers have promised to overhaul the Covid vaccine compensation scheme after criticism from the recent Inquiry.**
The scheme offers financial support to those injured or bereaved by vaccines in the UK. The government says it will now be reformed following scrutiny.
HEALTH · UK

3 **New rules banning pornography depicting choking or incest are set to come into force from early November.**
The move follows a government review into pornography regulation last year. It aims to strengthen protections against harmful content online.
POLITICS · UK

4 **There are concerns NHS staff may have improperly accessed the medical records of a man killed in a tiger attack.**
William Chapman, 24, died at Yorkshire Wildlife Park last Saturday. Police are now investigating potential breaches of patient confidentiality.
CRIME · UK

5 **Authorities face a "massive challenge" to protect former DUP leader Jeffrey Donaldson from harm in jail.**
Donaldson was sentenced to 15 years for historical sex abuse offences. Security concerns are high given his previous public profile.
CRIME · UK

02 — SHOWBIZ

# What's coming up

1 **Marvel fans can look forward to meeting a new Welsh superhero, complete with a Cardiff accent, in the new Disney+ series VisionQuest.**

Lauren Morais will play the villain Lisa Molinari. It's exciting to see more diverse regional accents in the Marvel universe!

ON AIR — What regional accents would you love to hear more of in big superhero franchises?

TV · COMING UP

2 **Robert Pattinson's new film 'Primetime' explores how hunting predators became hit TV.**

The actor portrays the real-life host of the American show 'To Catch a Predator'. It's a fascinating look at the blurred lines between justice and entertainment.

ON AIR — Would you ever watch a show that blurs the lines between reality and crime-fighting?

FILM · NEW RELEASE

3 **US singer-songwriter Ashe has revealed the story behind her international smash hit 'Stop The Wedding'.**

She admits she was too scared to cancel her actual wedding, and that experience inspired the song. It's amazing how personal stories can become huge hits!

ON AIR — What's a song that you love, but only recently found out the true story behind it?

MUSIC · NEW RELEASE

4 **Welsh singer Jamie Miller says collaborating on his 'Off Campus' track 'gave me chills'.**

His viral hit 'Babydoll' narrowly missed out on the UK number one spot. He's hoping to do Wales proud with his continued success.

ON AIR — Which rising music stars from your local area are you really rooting for right now?

MUSIC · NEW RELEASE

5 **Davina McCall has opened up about suffering memory loss after brain surgery, describing it as being like 'advanced Alzheimer's'.**

The TV presenter had an operation to remove a benign tumour. It sounds like a truly frightening experience, and so brave of her to share.

ON AIR — What's the bravest thing you've ever had to talk about publicly?

TV · NOW

03 — SPORT

# On the schedule

1 **Great Britain's Mark Stewart has won gold in a thrilling end to the men's points race at the Track Cycling World Championships.**

It was a fantastic performance from Stewart, securing a top spot for GB. The championships are providing some incredible moments!

ON AIR — Are you following the Track Cycling World Championships? What's been your highlight so far?

CYCLING · UK

2 **Another gold for Great Britain at the Track Cycling World Championships, with Anna Morris winning the women's omnium.**

Morris delivered a dominant performance in Shanghai to secure her medal. It's been a brilliant championships for the GB cycling team.

ON AIR — GB cycling always seems to do well on the world stage. What do you think their secret is?

CYCLING · UK

3 **Liverpool are buzzing about the feel-good story of Lewis Koumas, who broke a Steven Gerrard record.**

The young player has seized his opportunity under Andoni Iraola. He even admitted he couldn't sleep after playing against Manchester City!

ON AIR — Which young player are you most excited about in football right now?

FOOTBALL · UK

4 **Eighteen-year-old Thomas Rew is set to captain England Lions in the West Indies.**

This elevation shows how highly regarded Rew is by the England hierarchy. He's also just received his first senior call-up and central contract.

ON AIR — Is it good to give such young players captaincy roles, or should they focus on their own game?

CRICKET · UK

5 **Fading light has halted play at the DP World India Championship, impacting players including Rory McIlroy.**

The second round of the golf tournament was suspended due to the conditions. Players will have to return to complete their rounds.

ON AIR — Do you think golf tournaments should build in more flexibility for fading light, especially in autumn?

GOLF · NOW

04 — NEWSBRIEF

# Quick hits

1. **A charming new study highlights the calming effect of 'puddle-gazing' on a rainy day.**
   Researchers suggest that simply watching raindrops create ripples in a puddle can be a surprisingly effective way to de-stress and practise mindfulness.

2. **The simple act of 'sharpening a pencil' is being celebrated as a small, satisfying moment in our busy lives.**
   There's a quiet joy, it seems, in the whirring sound and the perfectly pointed tip, reminiscent of school days.

3. **Many are finding unexpected delight in 'organising their spice rack' into alphabetical order or by colour.**
   It's a small task, but the visual appeal and ease of finding that elusive turmeric can bring a surprising sense of accomplishment.

4. **The return of 'handwritten thank you notes' is making a comeback, bringing a personal touch to modern communication.**
   People are finding that a thoughtful, handwritten message carries more weight and warmth than a quick email or text.

5. **Discovering a 'perfectly ripe punnet of berries' at the supermarket is sparking small moments of joy for shoppers.**
   There's something uniquely satisfying about finding fruit that's just right, promising a delicious treat.

6. **A new trend encourages people to 'adopt a local bench' as a quiet spot for reflection and people-watching.**
   It’s about finding a small, regular haven in the community to sit, observe, and enjoy a moment of peace.

7. **The humble 'doorstop' is getting a moment in the spotlight as people seek out quirky and decorative designs.**
   No longer just functional, these little household items are becoming a way to add a touch of personality to a room.

05 — TALKBACK

# For the phone lines

## OUR SURVEY SAID

Q **Our survey said that over 60% of us admit to having a particular 'odd routine' they absolutely have to do before settling down to enjoy a lovely, new box of biscuits, especially if they're a fancy, artisan one. What is it?**

ANSWER: LOOKING AT EVERY SINGLE BISCUIT IN THE BOX, WEIGHING UP WHICH ONE TO HAVE FIRST!

Q **Our survey said that over 70% of us admit to secretly 'doing' what when trying to quickly judge if a new brand of tea will be good, even if we know it's not strictly scientific?**

ANSWER: GIVING THE BOX A GOOD SNIFF BEFORE THEY EVEN OPEN IT, JUST FOR THAT 'TEA AROMA' CHECK.

## TALK TOPIC

- **You know how sometimes a particular 'everyday sound' just instantly makes you feel a bit nostalgic or takes you back to a specific time?**
  What's that one sound – maybe the chimes of an ice cream van, the 'ker-chunk' of a public phone box, or the theme tune to an old children's TV show – that always transports you back in time?

- **We all have those little 'comfort items' that just make life better, don't we?**
  What's your go-to comfort item? Is it a particular mug, a favourite blanket, a certain book you always reread, or maybe even a specific pair of slippers? Tell us what it is and why it brings you comfort!

## TRUE STORY OR JACKANORY — LISTENERS GUESS

FACT **Nature.** Did you know that flamingos are not born pink? Their famous colour comes from the beta-carotene in their diet of brine shrimp and algae.

FICTION **Made up, but believable.** The Great Wall of China is the only man-made structure visible from space with the naked eye.

06 — LOTTERY

## Jackpots ahead

NEXT EUROMILLIONS JACKPOT

£3.4 million

Next Tuesday or Friday · estimated

NEXT NATIONAL LOTTERY JACKPOT

£3.4 million

Next Wednesday or Saturday · estimated

07 — FACTS OF THE DAY

## Did you know?

- A group of ferrets is known as a business.
- The inventor of the Pringles can, Fredric Baur, requested to be buried in one of his creations.
- Strawberry is the only fruit that wears its seeds on the outside.
- There are more possible iterations of a game of chess than there are atoms in the known universe.
- The 'sixth sick sheik's sixth sheep's sick' is considered the toughest tongue twister in the English language.
- Coconuts are classified as a 'drupe', which is a fruit with a hard stony covering enclosing the seed, not a nut.
- The distinctive scent of freshly cut grass is actually a distress signal from the plants.
- The world's largest snowflake ever recorded was 15 inches wide and 8 inches thick, found in Montana in 1887.

08 — TODAY'S DAY NOTES SAT 17 OCT 2026

# On this day

Day 290 of the year, 75 days left in 2026. Today Christian feast day: Anstrudis; Christian feast day: Catervus; Christian feast day: Ethelred and Ethelberht; Christian feast day: Florentius of Orange. Star sign Libra, birthstone Opal.

## TODAY'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1969 — Wood Harris, American actor
- 1966 — Mark Gatiss, English actor, screenwriter and novelist
- 1974 — Matthew Macfadyen, English actor
- 1960 — Guy Henry, English actor
- 1941 — Paul Ellison, American musician
- 1980 — Angel Parker, American actress
- 1971 — Derrick Plourde, American drummer (died 2005)
- 1948 — Margot Kidder, Canadian-American actress (died 2018)

## THE DAY TODAY

- 1965 — The 1964–65 New York World's Fair closes after two years and more than 51 million attendees.
- 2004 — A fire that lasted over 15 hours destroyed almost one third of the East Tower of the Parque Central Urban Complex in Caracas, Venezuela.
- 1991 — Rudrapur bombings by Sikh separatists, who explode two bombs, during a Ramlila Hindu celebration in Rudrapur, Uttarakhand, killing 41 people.

## TODAY IN MUSIC

- 1989 — The East German Politburo votes to remove Erich Honecker from his role as General Secretary.
- 1977 — The hijacked Lufthansa Flight 181 lands in Mogadishu. The remaining hostages are later rescued.

## TODAY IN HISTORY

- 1969 — The Caravaggio painting Nativity with St. Francis and St. Lawrence is stolen from the Oratory of Saint Lawrence in Palermo.
- 1994 — Russian journalist Dmitry Kholodov is assassinated while investigating corruption in the armed forces.

- 2019 — Drug dealers in Culiacan, Sinaloa, Mexico force the government to back down on an arrest.

09 — TOMORROW'S DAY NOTES SUN 18 OCT 2026

# A peek at tomorrow

Day 291 of the year, 74 days left in 2026. Today Alaska Day (Alaska, United States); Christian feast day: Asclepiades of Antioch; Christian feast day: Isaac Jogues; Christian feast day: Luke the Evangelist. Star sign Libra, birthstone Opal.

## TOMORROW'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1982 — Mark Sampson, Welsh footballer and manager
- 1967 — Eric Stuart, American singer-songwriter, guitarist, and voice actor
- 1961 — Gladstone Small, Barbadian-English cricketer
- 1947 — Joe Morton, American actor
- 1929 — Hillard Elkins, American producer and manager (died 2010)
- 1935 — Peter Boyle, American actor (died 2006)
- 1989 — Joy Lauren, American actress, director, and producer
- 1965 — Curtis Stigers, American singer-songwriter and guitarist

## THE DAY TOMORROW

- 1979 — The Federal Communications Commission (FCC) begins allowing people to have home satellite earth stations without a federal government license.
- 1914 — The Schoenstatt Apostolic Movement is founded in Germany.
- 1929 — The Judicial Committee of the Privy Council overrules the Supreme Court of Canada in Edwards v. Canada when it declares that women are considered "Persons" under Canadian law.

## TOMORROW IN MUSIC

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10 — FORWARD PLANNING · FILM

# Coming to cinemas

OCTOBER 2026 · PREVIEW

FRI 23 Frankenstein (del Toro)

11 — FORWARD PLANNING · SPORT

# On the sporting calendar



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